

Avoiding Vibe-Coded Website Patterns

1. CORE DESIGN & UX ENGINEERING PRINCIPLES

Colors & Visuals

- **No Generic Gradients:** Avoid default indigo/purple multi-color gradients unless strictly aligned with brand guidelines.
- **No Decorative Noise:** Remove sparkles, emojis, or floating shapes from hero section titles and metadata.
- **Eliminate Glows:** Replace high-blur colored drop shadows and ambient blur glows with crisp structural borders.

Typography & Scale

- **Weight Contrast:** Maintain standard weight gaps (e.g., 400 Regular to 600 Semi-Bold). Avoid 900 Ultra-Bold paired with 100 Thin.
- **Consistent Rhythm:** Apply uniform line-heights (1.2 for headings, 1.5 for body) and rigid paragraph spacing.
- **Strict Type Scale:** Define a maximum of 4 font size steps per page layout and enforce them globally.

Layout & Components

- Structure navigation and alignment identically across every page.
- Cap design tokens at 2 border-radius values (e.g., 4px sm, 8px md).
- Hover animations must be subtle (maximum 2–4px vertical shift).
- Remove dead/non-functional social media icon links.

Animations & Interactions

- Enforce deliberate cubic-bezier easing curves for all transforms.
- Stagger list/grid element timing systematically (20–50ms steps).
- Every motion must serve a clear function (feedback or transition).

UX Behaviors

- Provide explicit loading states for all asynchronous operations.
- Embed inline progress spinners/indicators within buttons on submit.
- Use content-matched skeleton screens for data-heavy components.

2. PRODUCTION COPYWRITING STANDARDS

Eliminate Buzzwords & Hype: Ban empty marketing adjectives including *unrivaled*, *revolutionary*, *game-changing*, *world-class*, and *seamless*.

Punctuation & Clarity: Remove em-dash overuse and vague callouts like "Launch faster" or "Build your dream". State explicit capabilities instead.

Concrete Technical Metrics: Replace broad value propositions with precise data. Use "Deploys in 40 seconds" instead of "Deploy in seconds".

Standard Functional Labels: Use explicit visual terms for buttons and links (*Sign Up*, *Documentation*, *Pricing*) rather than clever phrases.

3. DESIGN SYSTEM ENFORCEMENT MATRIX

Category	High-Vibe Pattern (Avoid)	Production Standard (Enforce)
Color	Multi-color background gradients, neon drop-shadows, ambient background blurs.	Solid neutral background tints, single primary brand accent, max 1 functional state color.
Typography	Oversized thin headings paired with ultra-dense body text; random font sizes.	Strict 4-step type scale (12px, 14px, 16px, 24px); 400 regular, 600 bold hierarchy.
Borders & Radii	Arbitrary mix of rounded-full buttons, rounded-xl cards, and sharp input borders.	Maximum 2 global radius tokens (e.g., 4px for controls/inputs, 8px for containers/cards).
Interactions	Scale-up hover zooms (scale(1.1)), glowing border pulses, infinite movement.	Subtle vertical translate (translateY(-2px)), 150ms cubic-bezier transition curves.
Components	Abstract floating shapes, non-functional icons, decorative live-status badges without real data.	Functional UI elements, real backend data connections, explicit empty and error states.

4. TECHNICAL IMPLEMENTATION CHECKLIST

CSS Variables & Tokens Architecture

```
:root { /* Radii Tokens */ --radius-sm: 4px; --radius-md: 8px; /* Spacing Scale (8pt Grid) */ --space-1: 4px; --space-2: 8px; --space-4: 16px; --space-6: 24px; /* Motion Curves */ --ease-standard: cubic-bezier(0.16, 1, 0.3, 1); --duration-fast: 150ms; }
```

Async Action Standards

- Implement content-matched skeleton blocks that match the EXACT dimensions of incoming data.
- Disable submit buttons immediately upon click to prevent duplicate request submission.
- Provide an explicit inline loading spinner alongside action text (e.g., "Saving...").

Interaction Audit Checklist

- Audit every interactive element for keyboard focus states (`:focus-visible`).
- Confirm that every icon button includes an explicit `aria-label`.
- Verify that all transitions terminate cleanly without layout reflow or text jitter.